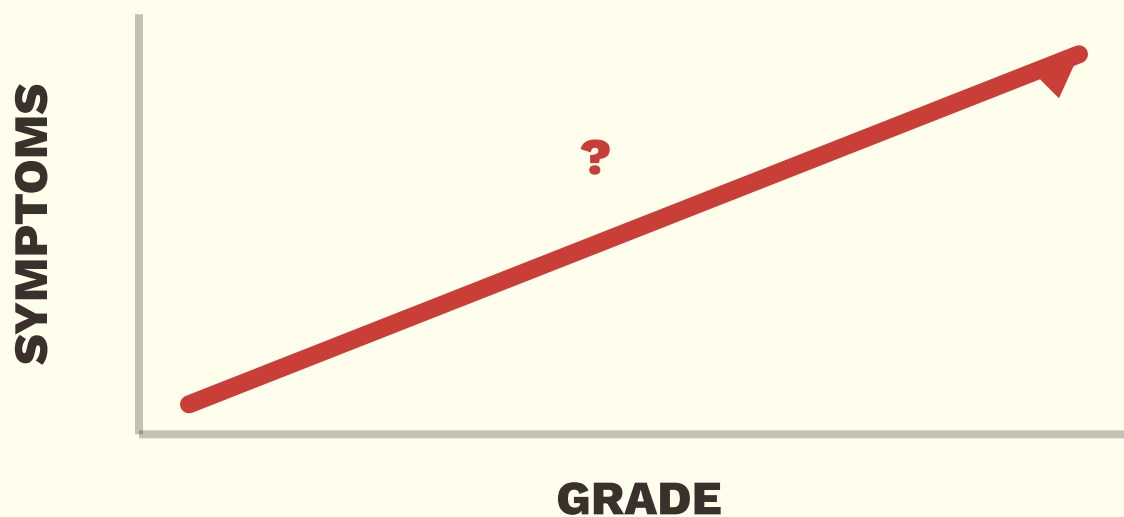


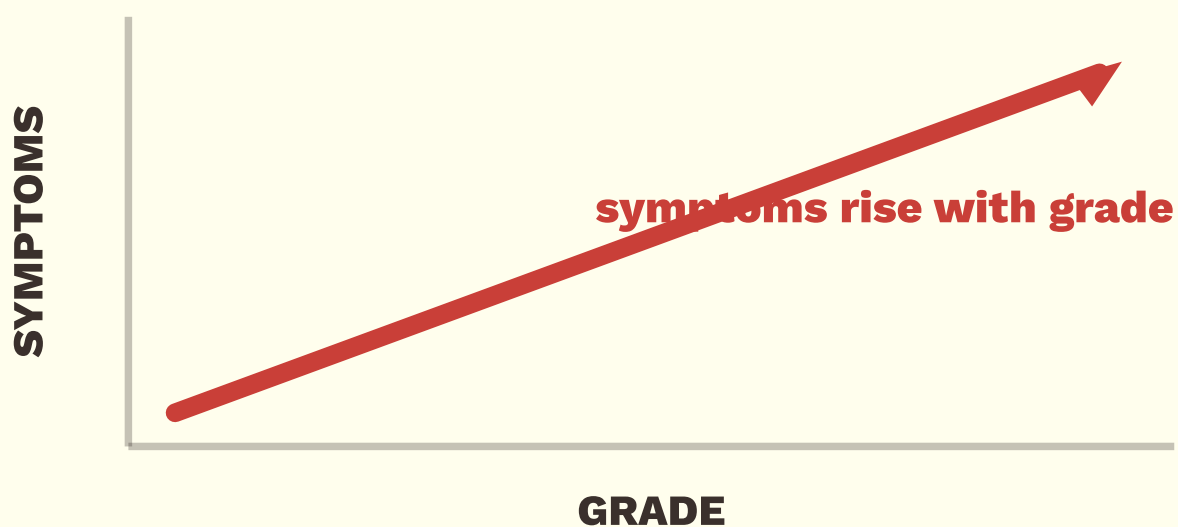
DOES A HIGHER GRADE MEAN **MORE PAIN?**

It is the assumption behind using symptoms to guide low risk shin bone stress. The evidence for it is two studies.



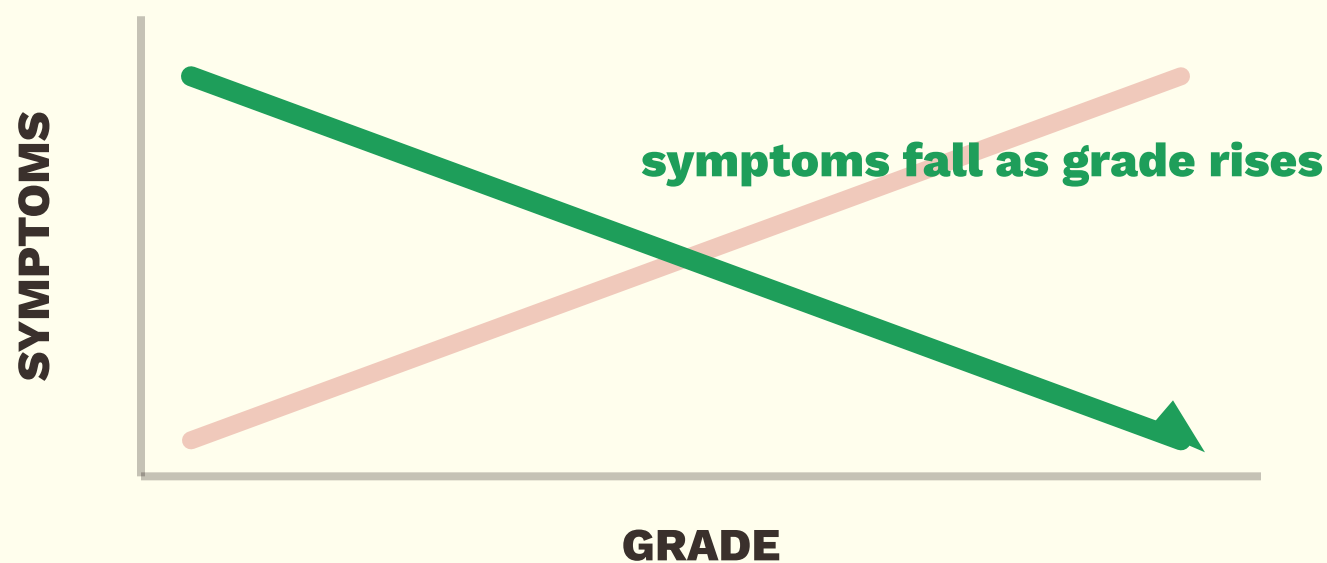
ONE STUDY SAYS **YES**

Fredericson and colleagues found lower grades gave diffuse tenderness, while higher grades gave more localised tenderness, and were more likely to hurt with percussion.



THE OTHER SAYS THE OPPOSITE

Beck and colleagues, looking more recently and more rigorously, found a higher grade was associated with **lower** clinical severity.

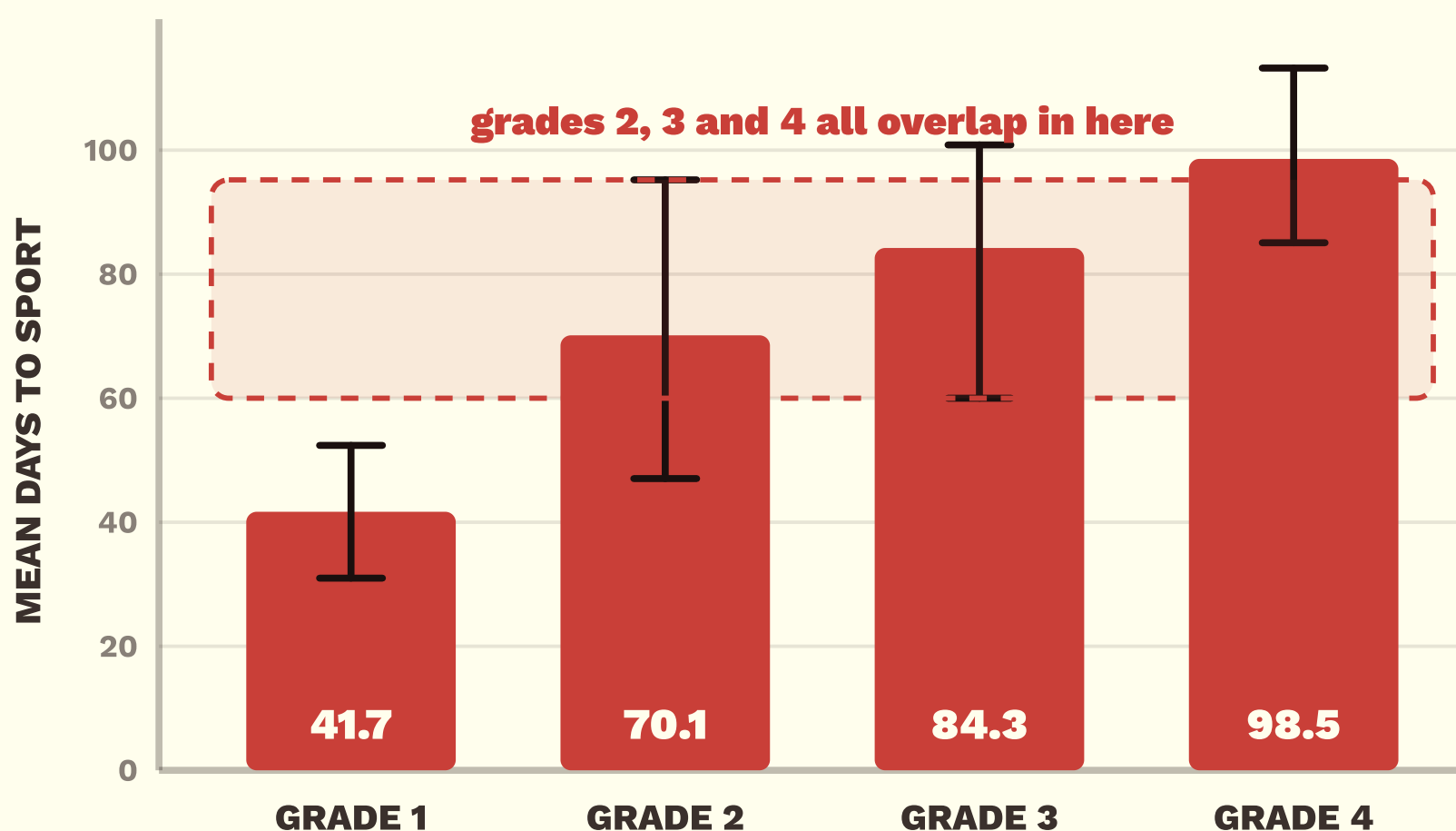


AND HERE IS ALL THE DATA **THERE IS**

	G0	G1	G2	G3	G4	TOTAL
Beck 2012	NA	7	11	18	1	37
Fredericson 1995	2	2	3	10	1	16

Grade 4 is the one with a fracture line. Between both studies, that is **two runners in total**.

GRADE DOES NOT EVEN CLEANLY PREDICT **RECOVERY TIME**



A grade 2 and a grade 4 can land on the same recovery time.
If the grade cannot pin that down, expecting it to track how much something hurts is a stretch.

SO NOBODY SHOULD ANSWER THIS CONFIDENTLY

Two small studies. They disagree with each other. And almost none of the runners in them had an actual fracture.

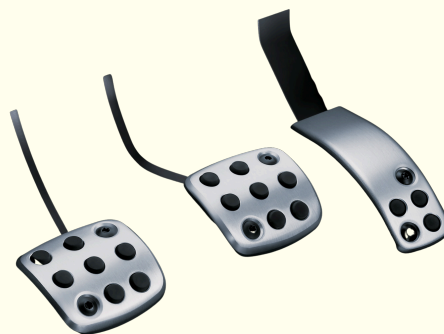


Whatever symptoms tell us about a fracture, this is not the data that shows it.



SYMPTOMS ARE NOT **USELESS**

They are just one weak signal being asked to carry an entire decision, on evidence that was never strong enough for the job. There is more to weigh than pain.



~~pain alone~~

site

load

energy

More on that soon.